

The Nation Turns West — and the Cities Rise

The Rise of Industrialization · 1877–1900 | Standards US.01, US.02, US.03, US.04, US.05, US.06, US.07

Name _____

- Archive (J. Troop)
- Spark
- Navigator
- Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

As America industrialized, the same forces — the railroad, the factory, the open door — meant opportunity for some and loss for others. Whose America was being built, and at whose expense?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

homestead	_____	assimilation	_____
	_____		_____
Jim Crow	_____	political machine	_____
	_____		_____
Gospel of Wealth	_____	nativism	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze how the Homestead Act and the transcontinental railroad drove westward settlement, and why the same expansion was opportunity for settlers... Notice: Here's the deal: move onto 160 acres, live there five years, plant something — and the land is yours. Free. Forever. No catch. Except the "empty"... Debrief: Anna and Chaska describe the same acres in opposite terms. Using one detail from each column, explain how the Homestead Act could be a genuine promise and a genuine injustice at the same time.	
2	Analyze how the reservation system, the Dawes Act, and boarding schools sought to dissolve Native landholding and identity through forced... Notice: New rules at your new school: they hold you down and cut your hair, hand you a brand-new name, and punish you every single time you speak the... Debrief: Reformers called the boarding schools and the Dawes Act a benefit to Native people. Give the intended goal and the actual effect of this assimilation policy.	
3	Explain how the Compromise of 1877 ended Reconstruction and enabled Jim Crow, and evaluate the Freedmen's Bureau's intended role through a period... Notice: Picture the refs strolling off the field at halftime — and the other team gets to write the rules for the next eighty years. That's about what... Debrief: The Compromise of 1877 is often described as the 'end of Reconstruction.' Explain what changed for Black Southerners like Isaiah when federal troops withdrew, using the cartoon and Isaiah's column as evidence.	
4	Analyze Gilded Age politics and economics — the power of trusts and machines and the divide between capitalists and wage earners — using a period... Notice: There's always a group that you're not in — the one where the real decisions actually get made. In 1889 a cartoonist drew America's version of it... Debrief: In 'The Bosses of the Senate,' the trusts are drawn as giants and the senators as tiny figures, with the 'People's Entrance' bolted shut. What is the cartoonist arguing about Gilded Age government, and which groups are left powerless?	
5	Describe how industrial leaders and innovations transformed American life, and weigh the Gospel of Wealth against the conditions of the workers... Notice: A billionaire posts about donating a hospital wing — while the people who actually built his fortune can't cover rent. Real generosity, or a... Debrief: Andrew Carnegie's 'Gospel of Wealth' and the 'Next!' cartoon describe the same industrialists very differently. Make a claim about how much the Gospel of Wealth justified Gilded Age inequality, cite both sources, and explain your reasoning.	
6	Analyze how industrialization and immigration drove the growth of major industrial cities and shaped urban labor and living conditions. Notice: Your town runs on people who can't afford to live in it — the drivers, the cooks, the crew cleaning the building at five in the morning. That's... Debrief: Using the Ellis Island photograph and the 1890 foreign-born map, explain the relationship between immigration and the growth of America's industrial cities.	
7	Compare 'old' and 'new' immigrants and analyze nativist responses, using a period photograph of tenement conditions. Notice: Same person steps off the boat. One country calls them an 'expat.' Another calls them an 'immigrant.' Another calls them a 'problem.' Same human... Debrief: Return to the essential question: whose America was being built, and at whose expense? Make a claim, cite evidence from at least two different spreads (including at least one image), and explain how opportunity and loss could be two sides of the same industrial expansion.	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 1 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **Golden Spike Ceremony at Promontory Summit, Utah, May 10, 1869 — completion of the first transcontinental railroad.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *Everyone in this famous photo is celebrating. Ask: who is not in the picture? Whose land and labor made this moment possible but were left out of...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1869	Homestead Act & transcontinental railroad		
1877	Compromise of 1877 ends Reconstruction		
1881	Tennessee's separate-car law		
1887	Dawes Act		
1890	Sherman Antitrust Act		
1892	Ida B. Wells's anti-lynching campaign		
1896	Tennessee ends convict leasing		
1901	NY Tenement House Act		
1911	Standard Oil broken up		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

This unit is one chapter of a project older than any of us - the one the Constitution names in its first line: forming 'a more perfect union.'...

Closing question: Look for a pattern across these seven stories: a problem gets ignored until it hurts people badly enough that someone refuses to stay silent - and their voice (a photograph, a newspaper, a strike, a vote) pushes the government to act. Sometimes the fix came fast (the Sherman Antitrust Act; Tennessee ending convict leasing). Sometimes it took generations (a federal anti-lynching law). Sometimes the government itself caused the harm (federal Indian policy). Choose two moments from this unit and argue, with evidence: in these years, did the country climb toward a 'more perfect union,' or slip back? There is no answer key - defend yours.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now: